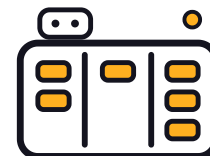


THE TASK BOARD LESSON • LESSON 5 OF 6

Robots Do the Boring Work



A 45-minute lesson on AI and future jobs. Your class runs a busy recording studio and decides which tasks go to AI, which get AI's help, and which stay human. Every choice has a trade, and students defend theirs out loud. Stands alone.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Studio Task Board worksheet (2 pages, 1 per student; fillable PDF copy included) · Slides (optional; script and keys in the notes) · board + marker for the three columns · Defense Rubric (Teacher Guide p.3) · pens	None — fully unplugged. Optional: a projector for the slides	Print worksheets. That's it.

OBJECTIVES & STANDARDS

- Sort real job tasks into **automate** / **augment** / **keep human** and explain the difference. (*Sort the Board; Exit Ticket*)
- Compare the tradeoffs of an automation choice — who wins, who loses something, what could go wrong. (*trade cards; Exit Ticket AUTOMATE line*)
- Defend a sorting decision aloud: a clear claim, a specific detail, eyes up, every word heard. (*Defend It — listener strip + Defense Rubric*)

CSTA 2-IC-20

CCSS ELA SL.6.4

ISTE 1.3.d

WARM-UP — THE MOST BORING JOB EVER (7 MIN)

Ask: "What's the most boring job you can think of?" Board 4–5 answers, then push on two or three of them:

"Is it boring because it REPEATS — same thing, over and over, no decisions? Or is it 'boring' but full of people stuff — helping, noticing, calming someone down?" Sort them as a class: repeats → give it to a robot; people stuff → keep it human. (A cafeteria cashier's job repeats — but the cashier also knows which kid forgot lunch money. Let them argue; the arguing is the point.)

Bridge (on slide 3, give pairs 30 seconds to talk first): "Here's the honest version, no robot apocalypse. Nobody can promise which jobs change, or how many. So far, AI mostly takes over tasks, not whole jobs. Usually the boring, repeating ones. But every time a business automates something, somebody wins, somebody loses something, and something could go wrong. Today YOU make those decisions — for a recording studio."

What if nobody names a people-stuff job? Try: "Bus driver — repeats the route, but notices who's crying in row six."

Transition: "So how do you decide what a robot should take? Three columns. Eyes on the board."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION — THREE COLUMNS, ONE QUESTION (10 MIN)

Draw three columns on the board (slide 4 if projecting) and define them. Say it out loud once: a "call" is a decision.

AUTOMATE — boring and repeating. No decisions to make. Hand it to AI.

AUGMENT — a human makes the call, AI helps out.

KEEP HUMAN — coaching, taste, being there for someone. The person is the whole point.

Tell the BPM story (1 min): "Back in the day, DJs counted every song's BPM, its beats per minute, by hand. Boring. But all that counting taught them the ins and outs of mixing. Now the software just tells you. The counting got automated. The job didn't. So who won? And who lost something?" *Listen for: they got time back, but beginners skip the lesson the counting taught.*

Watch one get sorted (Direct Instruction, continued): "Send the 'don't forget your session' texts." Column: AUTOMATE. Now the trade.

WHO WINS?	WHO LOSES SOMETHING?	WHAT COULD GO WRONG?
Jaylen — gets hours of his week back.	Jaylen, a little — sending those texts is how he learned every artist's name.	A cheerful reminder lands after a canceled session.

Say it plainly: "The column is the easy part. The trade is the real thinking. In this room, 'because robots' is not a reason. 'Who wins, who loses something, what could go wrong' — that's a reason."

What if a kid says "automate it all"? "Automate E — the nervous singer gets a chatbot coach. Who lost something?"

Hand-out: "One each, in pairs. Page 1: meet Nia, Ravi, and Jaylen, then read tasks A to L. Don't sort yet."

MAIN ACTIVITY — THE STUDIO TASK BOARD (15 MIN)

- Sort (8 min):** Pairs talk each task through; each student writes every letter A–L on their own board. Every column gets at least two. Partners may disagree, and either can be right. Keep slides 8–9 (the task list) up.

What if a pair is stuck? "Does it repeat, or is it people stuff?" Ten letters in AUTOMATE? "Which two would you hate to lose a person on?"

Transition: "Pens down. Page 2. Pick the TWO letters you argued about most — those are your trade cards."

- Trade cards (7 min):** Each student writes the trade for their TWO letters: who wins, who loses something, what could go wrong. Aim for one short sentence per question; if time is short, card #2 can be phrases.

What if an answer is "nobody loses"? Even Jaylen lost something. "Who used to do this task? What did they get from it?"

Transition: "Stop there. Now you have to say it out loud — to people who might disagree."

DEFEND IT — SAY IT OUT LOUD (8 MIN)

Teach the moves (1 min): "Three moves. Eyes up off the page. Loud enough that your listener hears every word.

And slow down on the word 'because.'" **Write (2 min):** students fill the claim frame (worksheet p.2): "Task ____ belongs in ____ because ____ — and the trade is ____." **Pairs of pairs (3 min):** two pairs sit together; each student faces one person from the other pair. Speaker 1 is the partner whose first name comes first in the alphabet. Speaker 1 reads (30 sec) and slides the sheet across; the Listener checks the three boxes, writes one keep and one fix (30 sec), and slides it back. Switch roles. Everyone ends with their own sheet. Sample 3–4 groups with the Defense Rubric (Teacher Guide p.3). **Whole class (2 min):** three students defend a choice to the room, voice to the back wall, or gallery-walk the boards.

What if a Speaker reads to the desk? Don't score it: "Eyes on us, one more time." The second try counts. **Odd number of students** → one group of three, in first-name ABC order: 1 reads to 2, 2 to 3, 3 to 1, and each Listener marks the Speaker's sheet. **Three pairs at one table?** Each student faces someone from another pair.

Transition: "You already have your own sheet — bottom of page 2. A job you actually know."

EXIT TICKET (5 MIN)

Worksheet p.2, bottom, solo: students pick **a real job someone in their life has** and sort three of its tasks. AUTOMATE names who loses something; KEEP HUMAN gives a why. Collect; key in Teacher Guide p.2.

What if a student says "I don't know anyone with a job"? "Your teacher has one. Sort mine."

DIFFERENTIATION

- Support:** Sort 8 tasks, not 12 (skip B, F, J, L; every column still gets two). Give trade-card starters: "____ wins because ____." · "____ loses ____." · "It could go wrong if ____."
- Extension:** Find one task where automating saves money now but hurts the studio in a year — explain the chain.
- ELL:** Sorting letters keeps writing low. Gloss "freestyle" (a rap made up on the spot). The claim frame is a language frame: argue in any language, present in English.
- No-device classrooms:** Built in: the lesson runs on paper and talk; a projector can show the task list.